ESPER
AWARDS
SCIENCE SOCIETY
D. S. SENANAYAKE COLLEGE
ESPER
AWARDS
SCIENCE SOCIETY OF D.S.SENANAYAKE COLLEGE

ESPER AWARDS

General Guidelines

- All entries must be the participants' own original work. Plagiarism or copied content is not allowed.
- No use of AI allowed.
- All entries should be appropriate to school students. Harmful or inappropriate content is not allowed.
- Any entry that does not comply with the rules or is unrelated to the assigned topic may be disqualified.
- Each participant representing a school must be currently entrolled in that school.
- If you experience any difficulty uploading files through the submission portal, please inform the organizing committee directly.
- Any concerns regarding the competition must be submitted to the organizing committee within the specified period.
- Kindly follow the competition-specific submission guidelines
- Late submissions will not be accepted.

ESPER AWARDS

INTER

ESPER AWARDS

EUREKA

Best Article Writer of the Year

Competition themes:

- Topic 1: The rapid advancement of AI and its effect on other industries as well as our day to day life
  කෘත්‍රිම බුද්ධියේ (AI) ශීඝ්‍ර දියුණුව සහ එය වෙනත් කර්මාන්තවලට මෙන්ම අපගේ එදිනෙදා ජීවිතයට බලපාන ආකාරය

- Topic 2: The rise of the surveillance state in the digital age
  ඩිජිටල් යුගය තුළ 'අධීක්ෂණ රාජ්‍යයක්' (Surveillance State) බිහිවීම

- Topic 3: The intersection between religion and science
  ආගම සහ විද්‍යාව අතර සම්බන්ධතාවය

Eligibility:

- Open to students from Grade 6 to 13.
- Entries must be Individuals
- A maximum of 3 students per school can participate.
- Each student may submit one (1) entry only

ESPER AWARDS

EUREKA

Best Article Writer of the Year

Submission Guidelines

- The document must be created on Google Docs.
- The provided Google Docs link **must have edit access enabled** to allow verification of version history and ensure no AI content was used.
- Insert the link to your Google Doc into the designated field of the official submission form that will be provided.
- The word count must be between 600–1000 words, written entirely in either English or Sinhala (select one language per entry).
- File name format EUREKA_Schoolname_TopicNo_Studentname
- Content must be strictly original and not previously published elsewhere. Plagiarism or the use of AI-generated content will result in immediate disqualification.
- Deadline for submission: 11.30.2026
- Submissions must strictly be made by an individual author.
- Any editing or modification of the document after submission is strictly prohibited and will be subject to disqualification.
- By submitting, the team agrees that the article may be shown, published, or promoted by the organizers.

ESPER AWARDS

DAEDALUS

Best Young Inventor of the Year

Competition themes:

- Topic 1: Assitive technology for the disabled
  ආබාධිතයන් සඳහා සහායක තාක්ෂණ
- Topic 2: Study tools for students
  සිසුන් සඳහා අධ්‍යයන මෙවලම්
- Topic 3: Practical tools that help in everyday life
  දෛනික ජීවිතයට උපකාරී වන ප්‍රායෝගික මෙවලම්

Eligibility:

- Open to students from Grade 6 to 13.
- Entries must be Individuals.
- Each participant may submit only one entry.

Submission Guidelines

- A video of you explaining the invention and the building process must be uploaded to Google Drive.
- You must change the General Access settings of the file from Restricted to "**Anyone with the link**" to ensure the organizing team has full access to the file.
- Attach the Google Drive link of the video to the submissions form.
- Innovation idea should be original.
- File format: MP4
- File name format: DAEDALUS_Schoolname_TopicNo_Studentname
- Deadline for submission: 11.30.2026
- Plagiarism or AI-generated content will result in disqualification.
- Submission should strictly be made by an individual.
- By submitting, the team agrees that the video may be shown, published, or promoted by the organizers..

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AGORA

Best Research Team of the Year

Competition themes:

- Topic 1: What is Actually Considered as Conscious Being?: A Deep Dive into Consciousness and its meaning
  සැබවින්ම සවිඥානික ජීවියෙකු ලෙස සැලකෙන්නේ කුමක්ද?: සවිඥානිකත්වය සහ එහි අර්ථය පිළිබඳ ගැඹුරු විමසුමක්

- Topic 2: Quantum computing and its effect on cryptography: what would happen to cryptography in the post quantum era?
  ක්වොන්ටම් පරිගණකකරණය සහ ගුප්තකේතනය කෙරෙහි එහි බලපෑම: පශ්චාත්-ක්වොන්ටම් යුගයේදී ගුප්තකේතනයට කුමක සිදුවේවිද?

- Topic 3: How Cognition and Perception Affect How We See the World: Uncovering the Workings of the Human Mind
  අප ලෝකය දකින ආකාරය කෙරෙහි ප්‍රජානනය සහ සංජානනය බලපාන අයුරු: මිනිස් මනසේ ක්‍රියාකාරිත්වය හෙළිදරව් කිරීම

Eligibility:

- Open to students currently enrolled in Grade 12 or Grade
- 13.
- Each team must submit one original research project.
- Teams may consist of 1 to 5 students.
- A maximum of two teams per school may participate.
- Each student may participate in only one team.
- Valid languages are Sinhala and English.

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AGORA

Best Research Team of the Year

Submission Guidelines

- Deadline for submission: 11.30.2026

Research Report

- PDF format only, uploaded directly to your team's Google Drive folder.
- The file name of the pdf should be as follows: AGORA_SchoolName_TeamNumber.pdf (the there are multiple teams from a single school, then those teams must have self-assigned a team number for themselves starting from 1)
- All data must be accurate, verifiable, and ethically sourced.
- A References section must be included, listing all sources used (books, articles, websites, interviews, etc.)
- Plagiarism, data fabrication, or uncited AI-generated content will result in immediate disqualification.

Presentation

- Each team must create a video presentation summarizing their research and findings.
- The duration of the video must not exceed 10 minutes.
- Upload directly to the same team Google Drive folder. And a link of the video must be entered to the submission form provided by us.
- Any presentation or editing software may be used (e.g. PowerPoint, Canva, OBS, CapCut, etc...).
- AI-generated presentations will result in immediate disqualification.
- By submitting, the team agrees that the Video and the pdf may be shown, published, or promoted by the organizers.

The folder link must be set to "**Anyone with the link**" with fully unrestricted access so the judges can open it instantly. Ensure there are no file restrictions or access permissions required to view or download the files.

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ALGORITHMOS

Edu Coder of the Year

Competition theme:

- **Background Scenario:**

Imagine you're joining the tech team at EcoSpark Innovations, a young startup that makes fun, smart tools for classrooms and local offices. Because the team is growing fast, things are getting a little chaotic! Equipment like projectors, laptops, and lab tools are constantly being moved around without anyone knowing who has what. On top of that, team members are storing project files, design notes, and guides all over the place, making it a pain to find what they need.

- **Your Goal:**

As part of EcoSpark's technical team, your challenge is to design and build a simple, easy-to-use company website that acts as an internal hub for the staff. The goal is to make daily operations smoother so everyone can easily check available gear and keep company files organized.

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ALGORITHMOS

Edu Coder of the Year

- **What Your Website Needs to Do:**

1. **Track Supplies & Gear:** Build a simple visual inventory page where staff can quickly see what items are available, search for specific equipment, and check if an item is currently "Available" or "In Use".
2. **Organize Files & Documents: C**reate a neat, folder-like structure or page where team members can view, search, and categorize important company files or project documents.
3. **Keep It Clean & Usable:** Focus on making the layout clean, responsive, and intuitive so any team member can jump on and start using it right away.

Eligibility:

- Open to school students (Grades 6–13) from recognized schools.
- Each team may consist of a maximum of three (3) members. Individual participation is also permitted.
- Each school can have up to 2 teams.

ESPER AWARDS

ALGORITHMOS

Edu Coder of the Year

Submission Guidelines:

- Deadline: 11.30.2026

Website

- All project source files, assets, and folders must be uploaded to a public or accessible GitHub repository.
- The link to the GitHub repository must be provided upon submission.
- The GitHub repository must include a text file (README.txt or README.md) in the root directory. This file must contain clear, point-by-point setup instructions explaining how to open, install dependencies (if any), and run the website locally.
- The website must be hosted online by the team itself.
- Any GitHub commits after the submission deadline will lead to immediate disqualification.

Presentation Video

- The video should include:
  Introduction of team and school
  Introduction of their software
  Explanation of features and workflow
  Demonstration of the software in action
- Both the completed 10-minute video and the video script (as a PDF) must be uploaded to Google Drive (placed within a single shared folder or as separate files under the same shared folder link).

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ALGORITHMOS

Edu Coder of the Year

- Change the General Access settings of the file/folder from **"Restricted"** to **"Anyone with the link"** to ensure the organizing team has full access to view and download both assets.
- **File Naming:** ALGORITHS_Schoolname_TopicNo

Final Submission Checklist

Submit the following items through the official submission form provided by the organizers:

1. Live Hosted Website Link (self-hosted by the team)
2. GitHub Repository Link (with mandatory README.md/README.txt and strict pre-deadline commits)
3. Google Drive Link (containing both the 10-minute video and the video script PDF, with **"Anyone with the link"** permissions enabled)

Evaluation Criteria

- **Innovation & Creativity:** 25%
- **Functionality & Usability:** 25%
- **Scenario Relevance:** 25%
- **Presentation & Documentation (GitHub/Setup/Video):** 25%

By submitting, the team agrees that the source code, video may be shown, published, or promoted by the organizers.

ESPER AWARDS

AESTHETIKOS

Graphic Designer of the Year

Themes:

THE UNSEEN — Visualize the Invisible

Create a poster that makes an invisible scientific phenomenon visible through creative design.

Concepts: gravity, magnetic fields, time, sound, microscopic life, dark matter.

Eligibility:

- The competition is open to students from Grade 6 to Grade 13.
- The post ratio is 4 : 5
- A maximum of 18 students per school can participate.
- Each student may submit one (1) entry only.
- The design must reflect the theme(Elements used in the project must send in pst format) (AI generated posts aren't allowed)
- Designs can be created using digital software (Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, Canva, etc.) or drawing apps on tablets.

ESPER AWARDS

AESTHETIKOS

Submission Guidelines:

- Submit designs in JPEG, PNG, or PDF format.
- Maximum file size: 100 MB.
- Basic editing and digital enhancements are allowed.
- Plagiarism or copying from others is strictly prohibited.
- The image must be saved like, AESTHETIKOS_Schoolname_Studentname
- Elements used in the project must be submitted in pst or jpg,png formats.
- Change the General Access settings of the file/folder from "Restricted" to **"Anyone with the link**" to ensure the organizing team has full access to view and download both assets.
- Submissions must be sent through submission Form.
- Deadline for submission: 11.30.2026
- Late or incomplete entries will not be accepted.
- By submitting, participants agree that their designs may be displayed, published, or used for promotion by the organizers.

ESPER AWARDS

MOST POPULAER SCIENCE UNION OF THE YEAR

Registration:

- To enter the competition, the representative must fully complete the official registration form available at the ESPER Inter-School Registration Portal
- By submitting the form, the applicant confirms they possess the formal authority to register on behalf of their school's Science Union
- Deadline for registration: 11.30.2026

Fair Play & Anti-Cheating Policy:

- The use of any automated tools, bot applications, or paid online engagement services to artificially boost votes, likes, or shares is banned. Any school union found using these methods will face immediate disqualification.
- If any unusual, suspicious, or inorganic growth spikes in voting/engagement metrics are detected, the organizing committee reserves the absolute right to disqualify the offending school immediately without prior notice.
- Only votes and engagements coming from authentic, active human accounts will be counted toward the final tally.

ESPER AWARDS

MOST POPULAER SCIENCE UNION OF THE YEAR

Voting Mechanics & Platforms:

- All official voting is conducted exclusively through the Science Society of D.S. Senanayake College's Official Instagram Page and the official SSDSSC WhatsApp Channel.

https://www.instagram.com/ss.dssc

https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VaibVtAGufIrsQvVFV1J